

65/20 Citizenship Test: The 20 Questions and Answers

For applicants 65 or older with 20 or more years as a permanent resident. The officer asks 10 of these; 6 correct passes. May be taken in the applicant's language. Printed from citizenshippal.com. Free to copy for classroom use.

Principles of government

- 2. What is the supreme law of the land? ★**
 - The Constitution
- 7. How many amendments does the U.S. Constitution have? ★**
 - Twenty-seven (27)
- 12. What is the economic system of the United States? ★**
 - Capitalism
 - Free market economy

System of government

- 20. Name one power of the U.S. Congress. ★**
 - Writes laws
 - Declares war
 - Makes the federal budget
- 30. What is the name of the Speaker of the House of Representatives now? ★**

Mike Johnson (as of September 5, 2026; confirm at uscis.gov/citizenship/testupdates)
- 36. The President of the United States is elected for how many years? ★**
 - Four (4) years
- 38. What is the name of the President of the United States now? ★**

Donald Trump (as of September 5, 2026; confirm at uscis.gov/citizenship/testupdates)
- 39. What is the name of the Vice President of the United States now? ★**

JD Vance (as of September 5, 2026; confirm at uscis.gov/citizenship/testupdates)
- 44. Who vetoes bills? ★**
 - The President
- 52. What is the highest court in the United States? ★**
 - Supreme Court
- 61. Who is the governor of your state now? ★**

Answers will vary. Depends on your state.

Rights and responsibilities

- 66. What do we show loyalty to when we say the Pledge of Allegiance? ★**
 - The United States
 - The flag

Colonial period and independence

- 74. Who lived in America before the Europeans arrived? ★**
 - Native Americans
 - American Indians
- 78. Who wrote the Declaration of Independence? ★**
 - Thomas Jefferson

86. George Washington is famous for many things. Name one. ★

- First president of the United States
- “Father of Our Country”
- General of the Continental Army
- President of the Constitutional Convention

The 1800s

94. Abraham Lincoln is famous for many things. Name one. ★

- Freed the slaves (Emancipation Proclamation)
- Saved the Union
- Led the United States during the Civil War
- 16th president of the United States
- Delivered the Gettysburg Address

Recent history

113. Martin Luther King, Jr. is famous for many things. Name one. ★

- Fought for civil rights
- Worked for equality for all Americans
- Worked to ensure that people would “not be judged by the color of their skin, but by the content of their character”

115. What major event happened on September 11, 2001 in the United States? ★

- Terrorists attacked the United States
- Terrorists took over two planes and crashed them into the World Trade Center in New York City
- Terrorists took over a plane and crashed into the Pentagon in Arlington, Virginia
- Terrorists took over a plane originally aimed at Washington, D.C., and crashed in a field in Pennsylvania

American symbols

121. Why does the flag have 13 stripes? ★

- Because there were 13 original colonies
- The stripes represent the original colonies

National holidays

126. Name three national U.S. holidays. (name three) ★

- Independence Day
- Thanksgiving Day
- Christmas Day
- New Year’s Day
- Martin Luther King, Jr. Day
- Presidents Day
- Memorial Day
- Labor Day
- Columbus Day
- Veterans Day